# Research Skills in Psychology

26/27

# Who am I?

# Who are YOU?

# Why do we need science?

- Scientific funding has been **under scrutiny**

NEWS | 28 October 2024

## Far-right governments seek to cut billions of euros from research in Europe

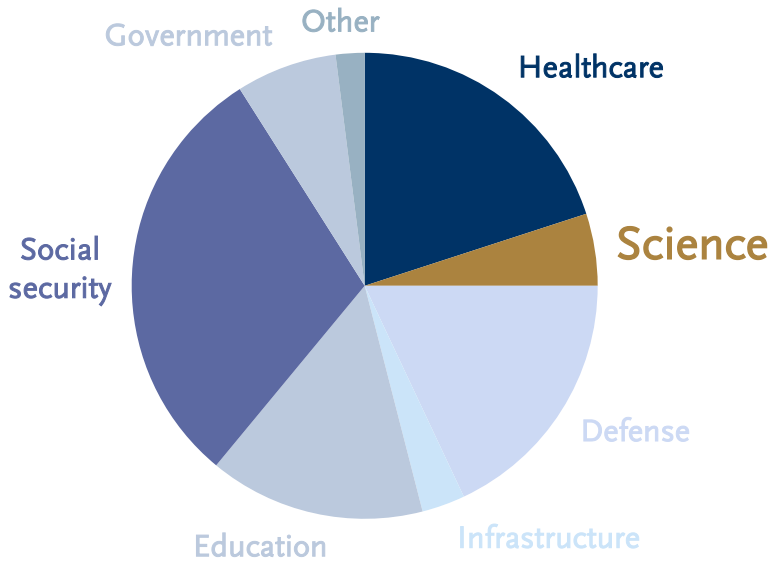
**Anti-immigration parties are pushing policies that are hostile or indifferent towards science.**

## Colleges and universities must show their economic value, according to the House of Representatives

Higher Education Press Office • 09 September 2026 • 11:10

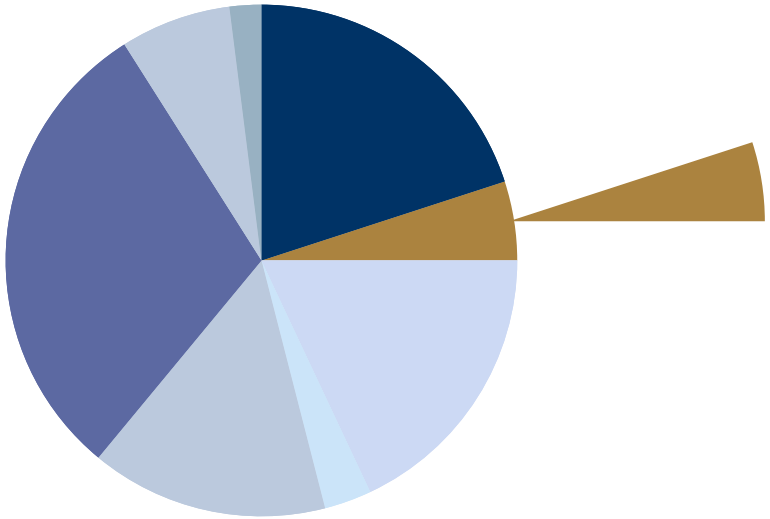
**From patents to spin-offs, to what extent do colleges and universities contribute to the Dutch economy? They have to map that out, according to a large majority of the House of Representatives.**

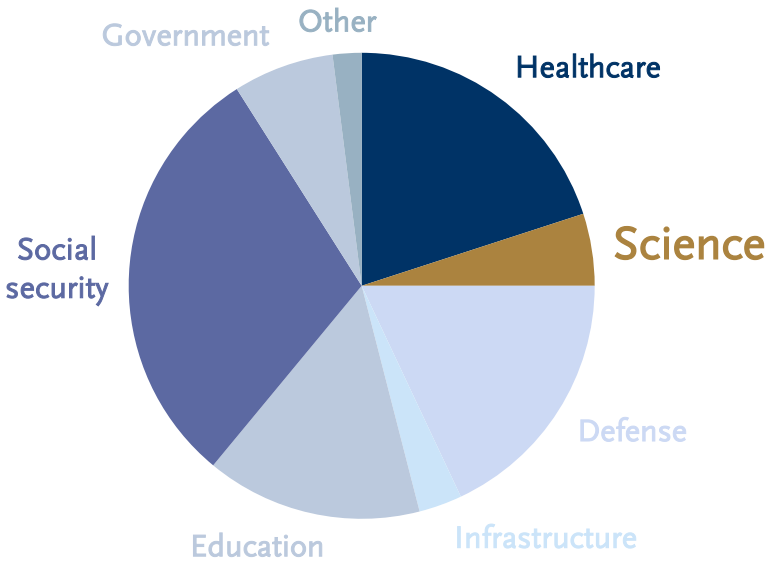
With their assault on science, Trumpists aren't just harming America – they're harming themselves




*This is an illustrative example.*

- Scientific funding has been **under scrutiny**
- **Scientific budget is limited** (and has been getting even more limited)






*This is an illustrative example.*

Further split into disciplines:
- Social sciences
- Medical sciences
- Humanities
- Technology…

- At the same time… the public's trust in science has been challenged

NEWS | 22 April 2026

# 'Staggering' number of people believe unproven claims about vaccines, raw milk and more

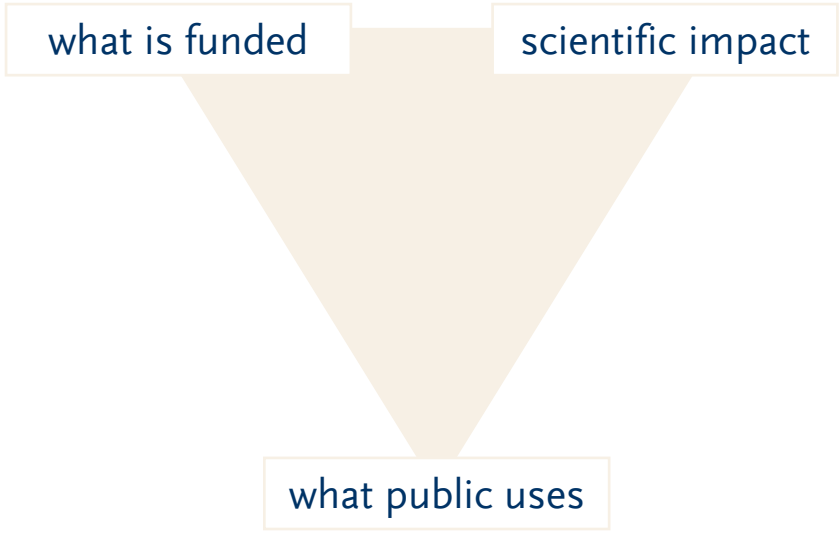
**Survey results suggest a rise in questioning of scientific evidence.**

BUSINESS RATHENAU INSTITUTE SURVEY SCIENCE UTRECHT AMSTERDAM
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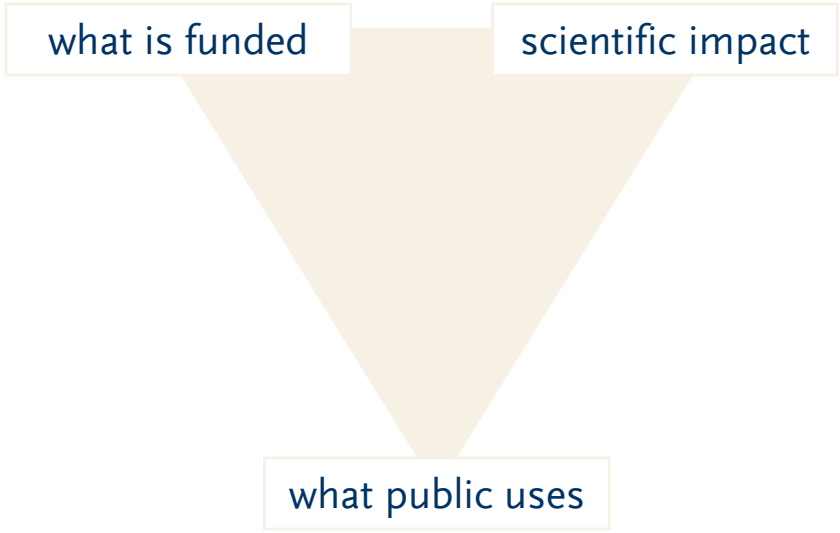
SATURDAY, 19 JULY 2025 - 07:45

## No middle ground: Dutch either trust science completely, or not at all




Yin et al. (2022)

# Does the public see this too?




Yin et al. (2022)

# How are we going to explore this?

## Data

Online data collection (~120 participants)

Validated questionnaires + novel experimental task



## Population

Depends on your data collection efforts and interests

qualtrics XM

## Analyses

Depend on your research questions :)

# What is a research proposal?

Doing research is a lot like building a house

- Requires a lot of planning (drawing, permits, design, …)
- Requires teamwork (architects, builders, electricians, …)
- Is affected by a lot of external factors (weather, fatigue, other responsibilities, …)

A proposal is **essential** in order to account for all potential hurdles

- It is a **research plan** that simplifies and guides final work



# How to write a proposal?

1. Read the literature previously shared with you. You can read all of it, or you can split up the work with your group members.
2. Find a set of variables you are **genuinely** interested in exploring and share them with your group.
3. Think about the measures and analyses you can use **to research these variables**. Refer to the planned questionnaires and scales. Share this with your group.
4. Together with your group, decide which variables to go with. Try to assess if your statistical knowledge can properly research these variables.
5. Formulate a research question and hypotheses with this set of variables.
6. Write all the plans up, together with all other parts of the proposal.



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## DEFINITELY INCLUDED

**SCIENCE-RELATED:** psychological distance to science, opinions about science funding, belief in science, attitudes towards science credibility, current understanding of science, science-related populist attitudes

**BELIEF-RELATED:** human values, political identity

**DEMOGRAPHIC:** age, gender, occupation

**EXPERIMENTAL:** funding judgment based on funded research

## CAN BE INCLUDED

**BELIEF-RELATED:** sexist attitudes, paranormal beliefs

**BEHAVIOR-RELATED:** social media use (e.g., certain platforms – Y/N questions, time spent on social media per week – self-report), self-reported AI use...

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You **do not have** to choose the funding variables!

I would suggest using variables gathered from validated questionnaires for simplicity.

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Important to **plan ahead.** You should not change the RQ and hypothesis after starting the research.

A hypothesis is **an educated prediction** for the research question.
It specifies **the population to which it applies, it is quantifiable, and testable**.

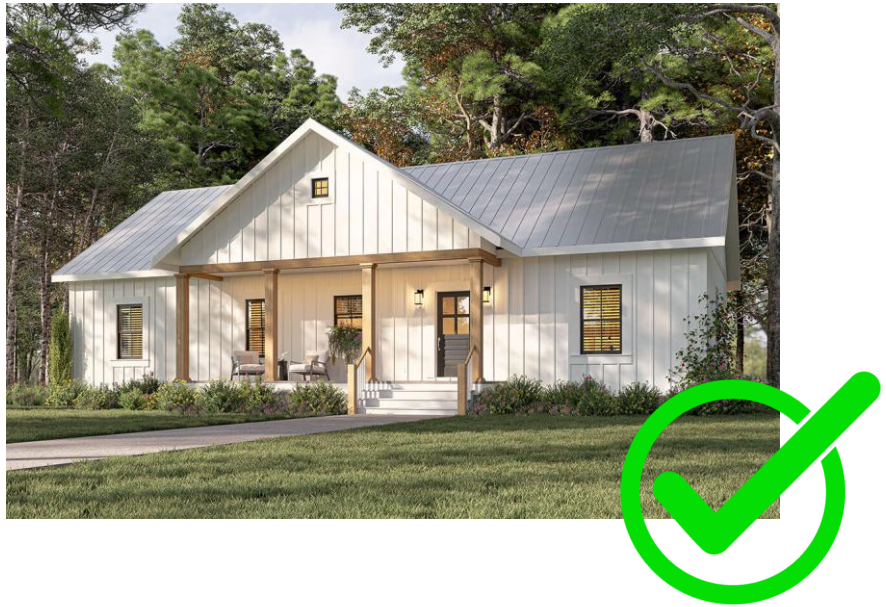
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You can find the detailed guidelines on the RSiP website I shared.

# If you plan well...





# Some tips

- A replication + extension is always a good reason for new research.
- It is better to do valid than novel research.
- Try to look for topics that **interest you**. You can use **any** of the variables.
- I would suggest doing a T-Test, a regression analysis, or an ANOVA.

*P. S. If you want to add a new measure, let me know ASAP, so I can add it before December.*

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# A small tutorial on **reference management**

...or how to simplify citations:)

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# How to track references

You can do this manually, there are also websites that do this.

However – best option is using a **reference manager like Zotero**

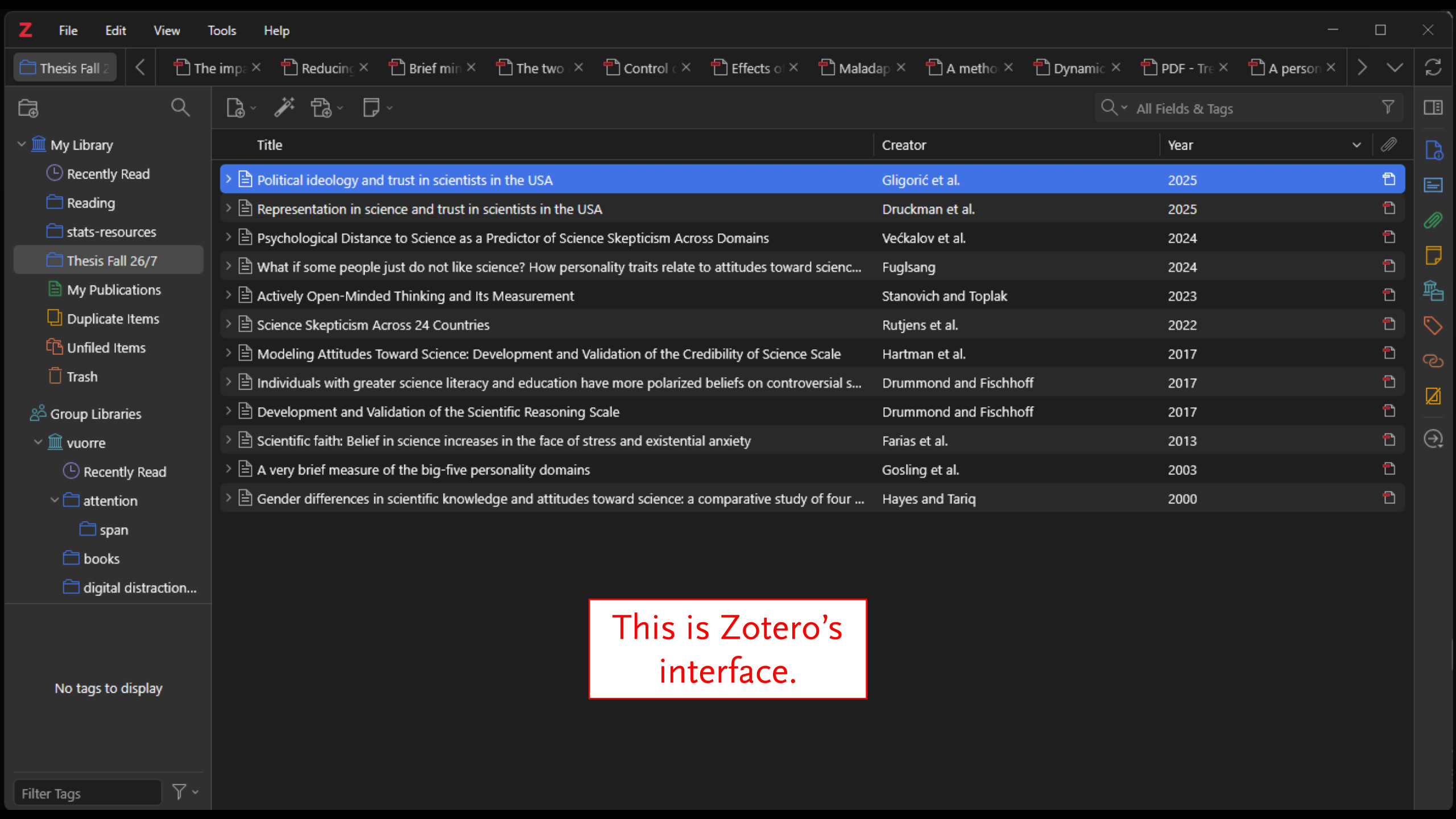
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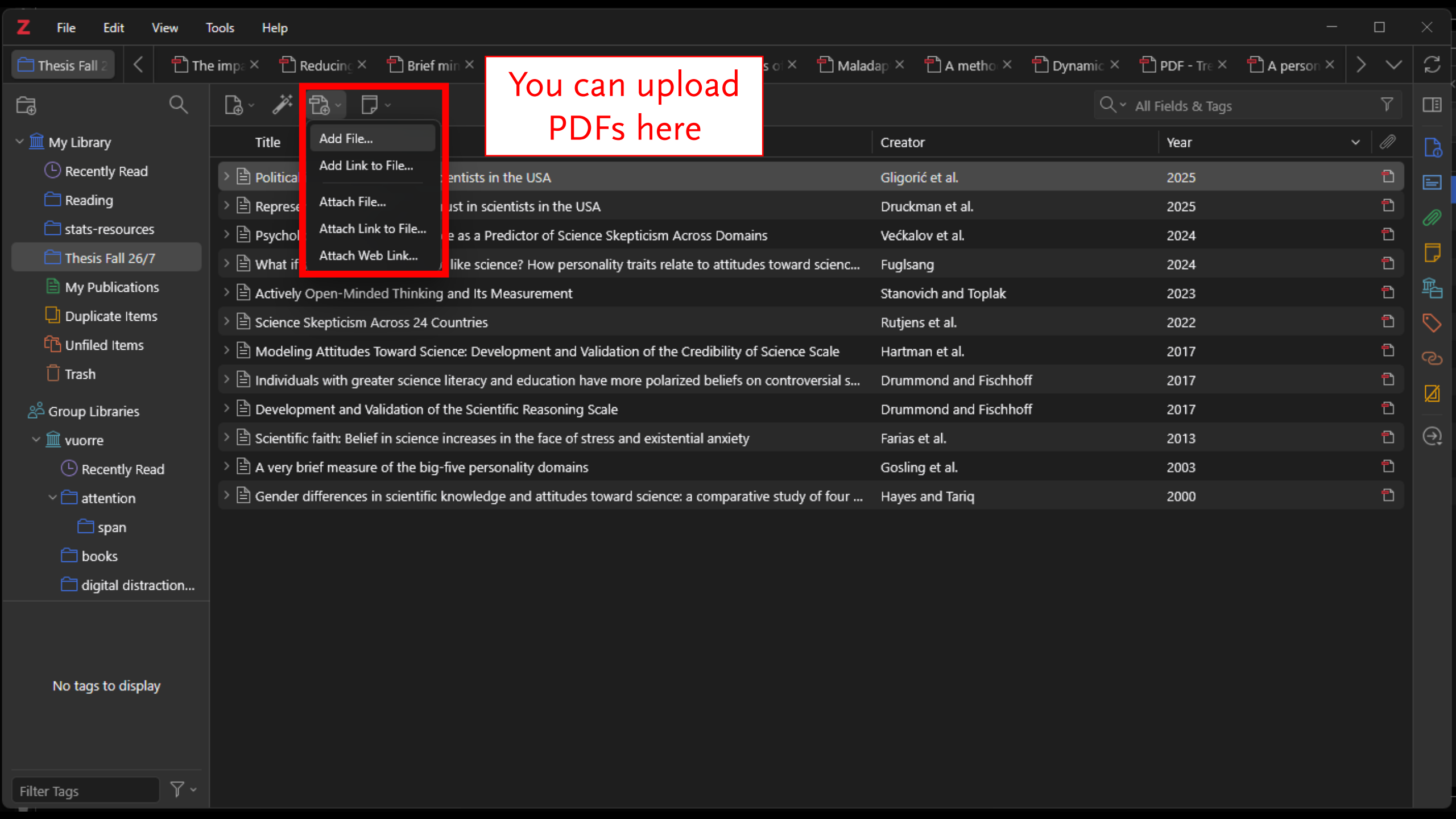
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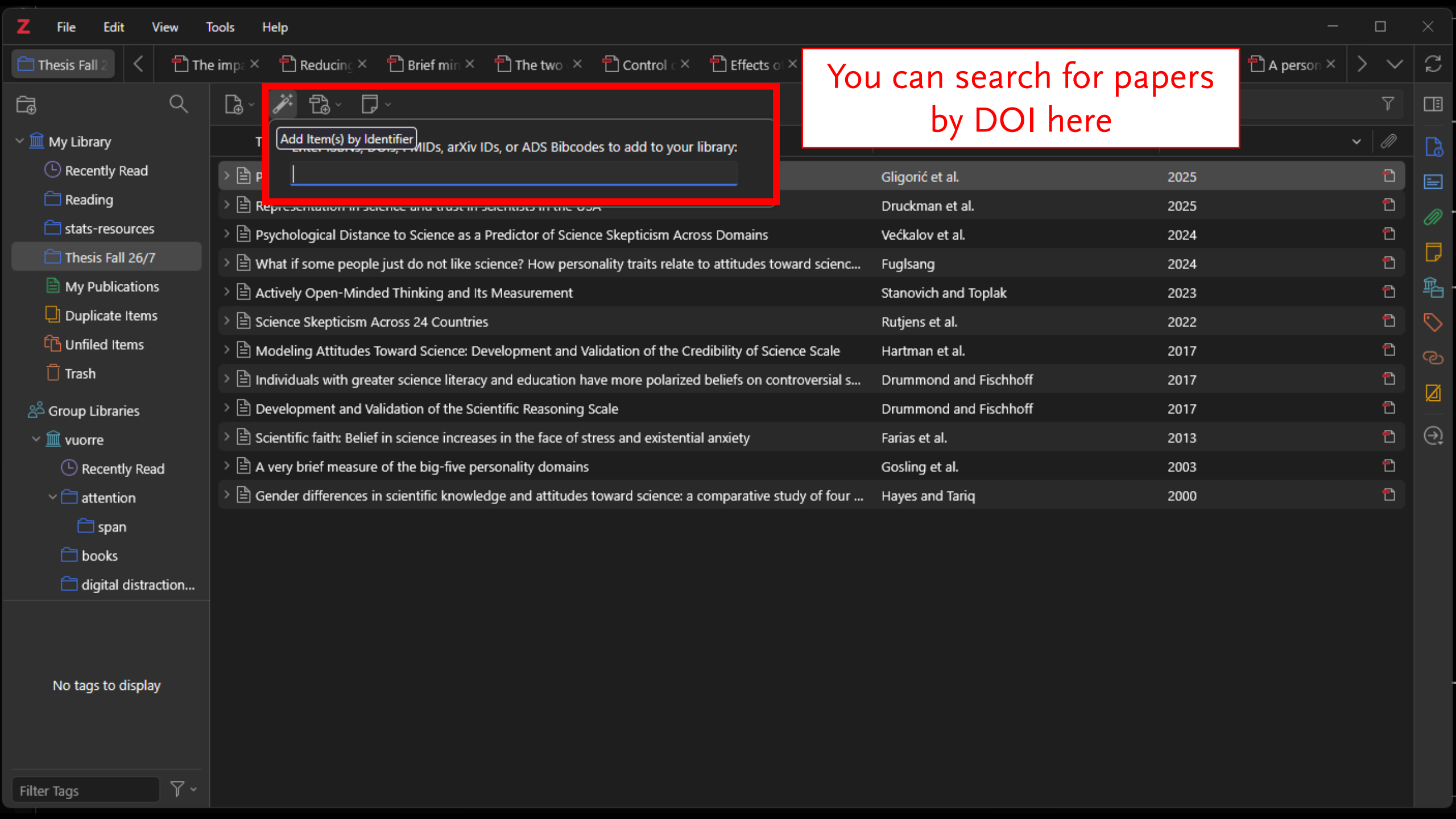


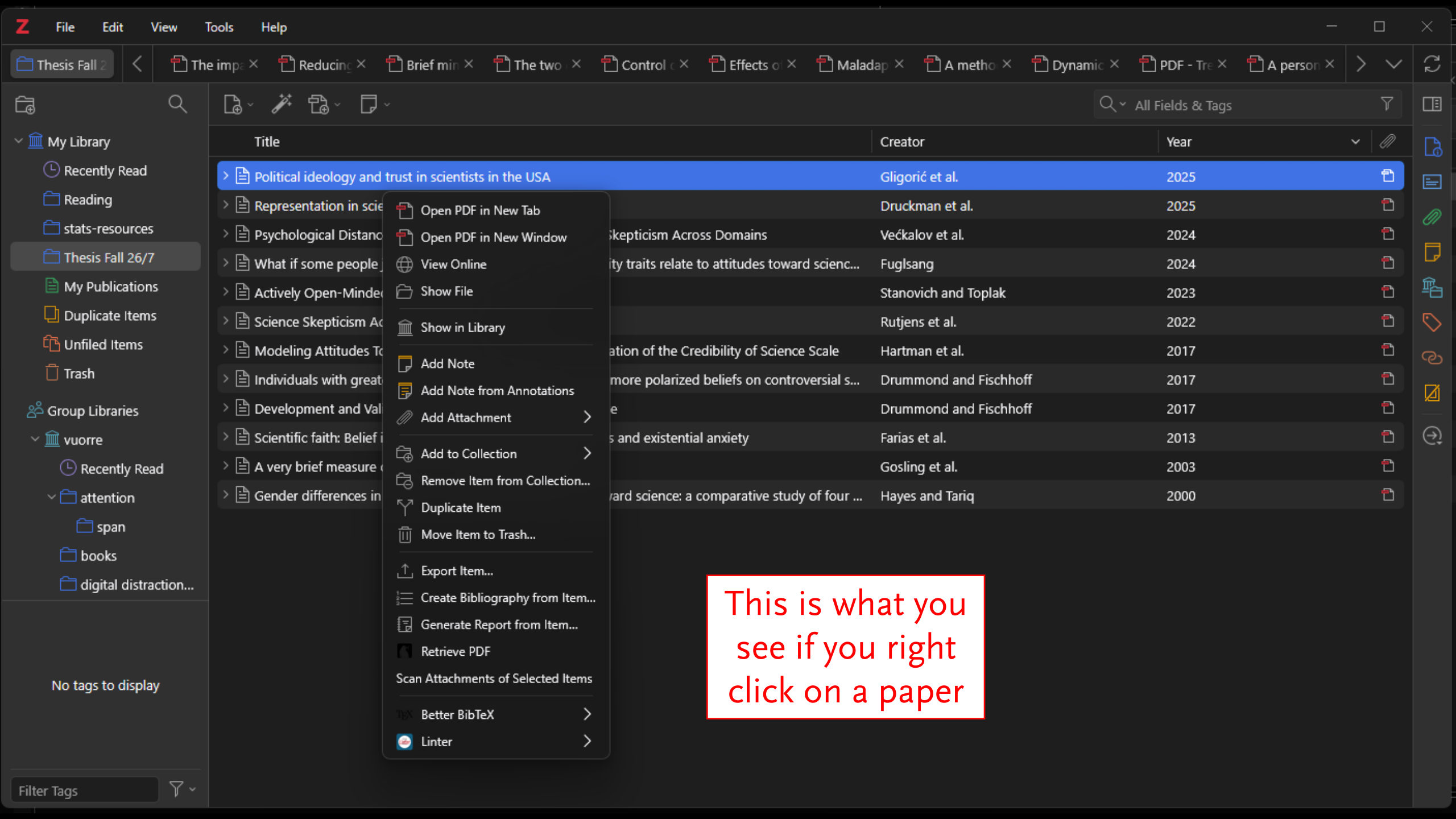

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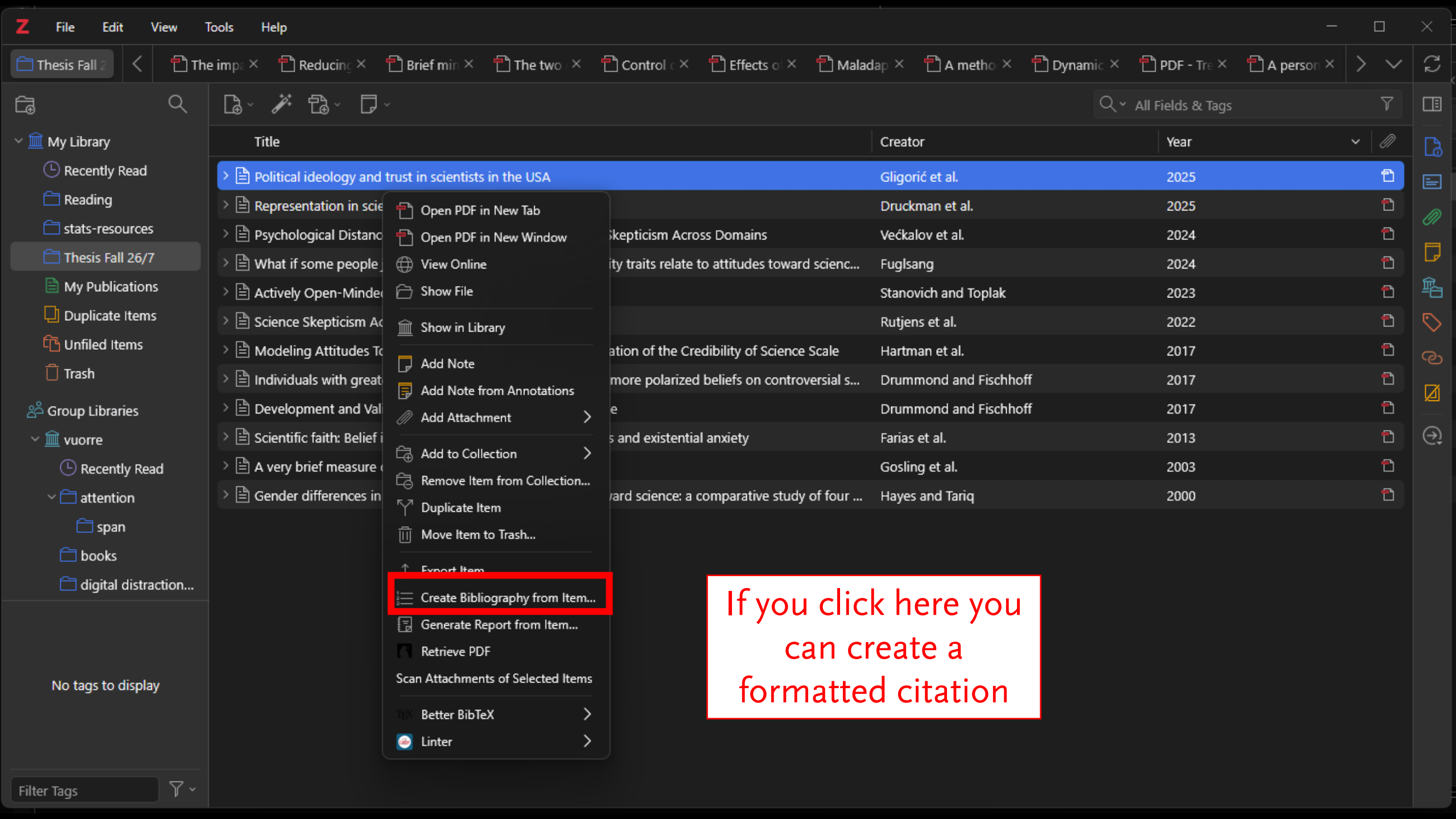
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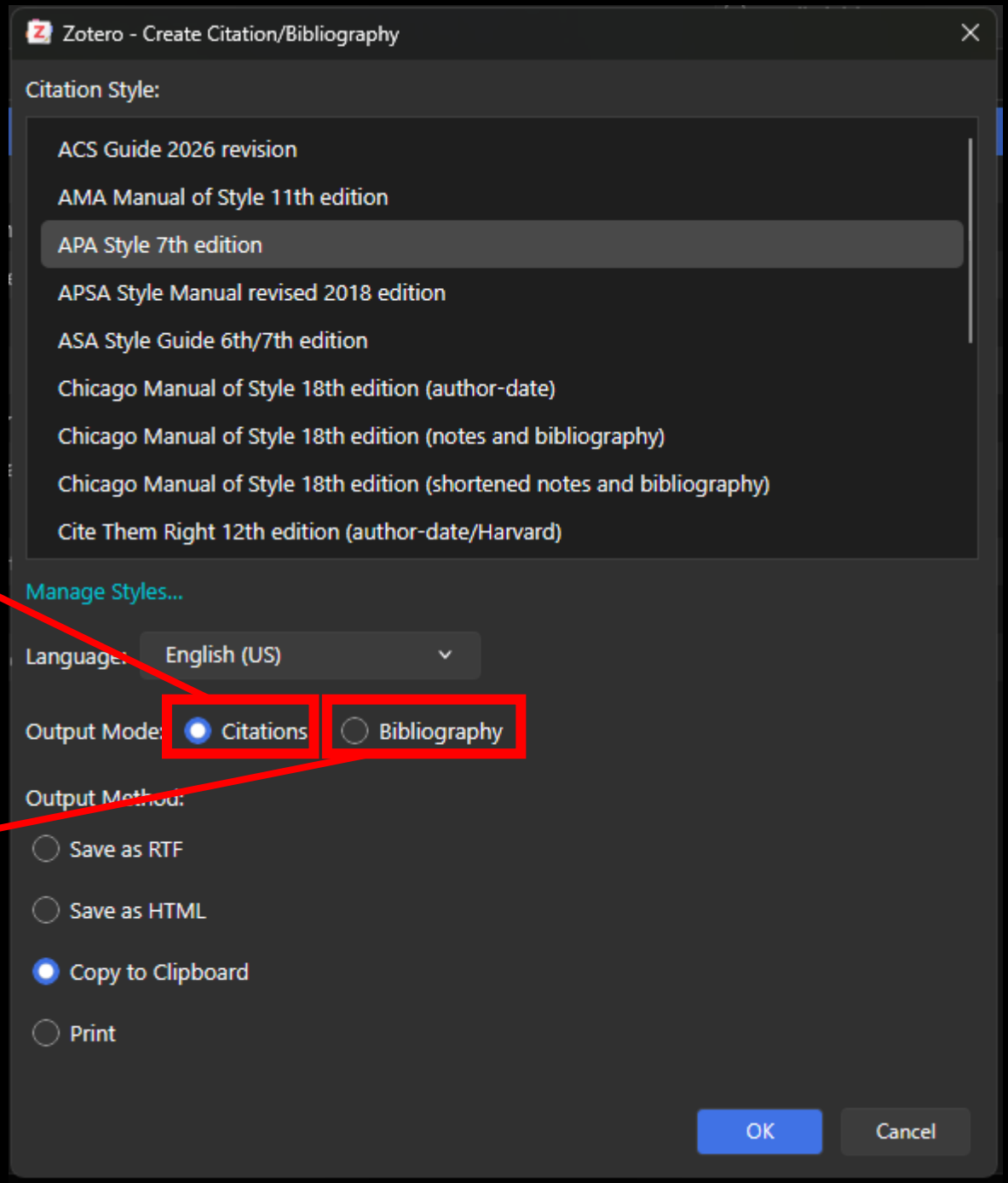

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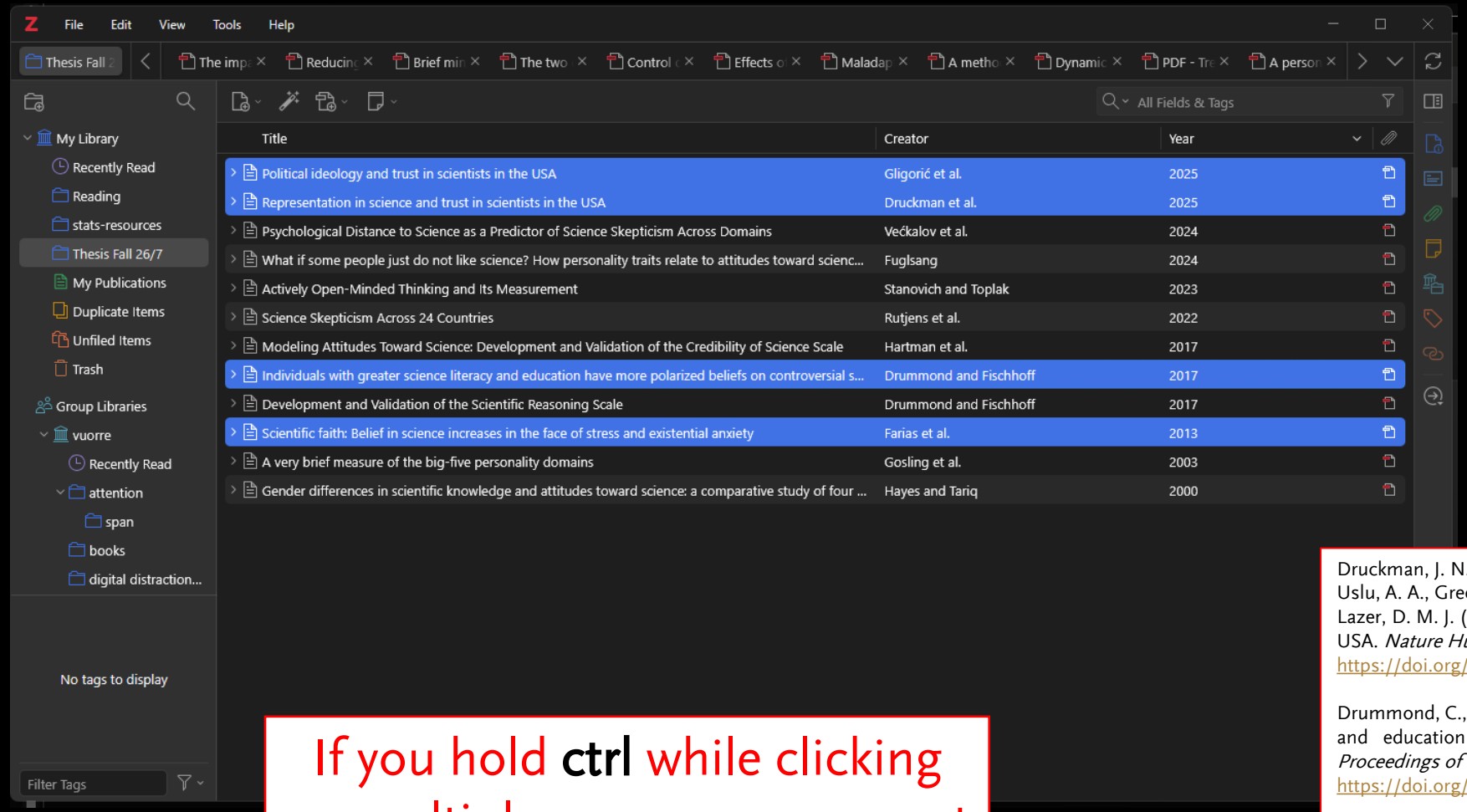
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(Gligorić et al., 2025)

Gligorić, V., Van Kleef, G. A., & Rutjens, B. T. (2025). Political ideology and trust in scientists in the USA. *Nature Human Behaviour*, *9*(7), 1501–1512. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-025-02147-z



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Drummond, C., & Fischhoff, B. (2017). Individuals with greater science literacy and education have more polarized beliefs on controversial science topics. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *114*(36), 9587–9592. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1704882114

Farias, M., Newheiser, A.-K., Kahane, G., & De Toledo, Z. (2013). Scientific faith: Belief in science increases in the face of stress and existential anxiety. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, *49*(6), 1210–1213. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2013.05.008

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# Do you have any questions

- About the planning
- About the project
- About your next task
- About me...?

If in doubt…

- Check the website
- Check the syllabus (Canvas)
- Contact your fellow students
- Contact me

l.soric@tilburguniversity.edu